



Mostly sunny, hot 97/79 • Tomorrow: T-storm 94/77 **B20**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

FRIDAY, JULY 25, 2025 • \$4

Parent of CBS wins merger approval

FCC signs off on deal after lawsuit settlement, pledge to review content

BY JEREMY BARR

The Federal Communications Commission on Thursday formally approved the \$8 billion merger of CBS parent company Paramount and Skydance Media, ending a more than 250-day review process marked by controversy and accusations of inappropriate political pressure.

The vote was 2-1, with Democratic-appointed commissioner Anna M. Gomez opposing the transaction.

“Americans no longer trust the legacy national news media to report fully, accurately, and fairly,” FCC Chairman Brendan Carr said in a statement. “It is time for a change. That is why I welcome Skydance’s commitment to make significant changes at the once storied CBS broadcast network.”

A Paramount spokesperson declined to comment.

Earlier this week, Skydance agreed to several major concessions that “pleased” Carr, as he said during a news conference earlier Thursday. Skydance pledged to conduct a review of CBS’s content and to appoint an ombudsman to handle claims of bias. The network also agreed to refrain from diversity, equity and inclusion programs, another Carr priority.

“These commitments, if implemented, would enable CBS to operate in the public interest and focus on fair, unbiased, and fact-

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Epstein article: Trump suit against Murdoch sends a message. **A6**

Fed renovation: Trump and Powell view construction at buildings. **A16**



MAHMOUD ISSA/REUTERS

Samah Matar holds her malnourished son Youssef, who has cerebral palsy, at the Gaza City school where they are sheltering.

Deaths rise as Gazans face starvation

This article is by Louisa Loveluck, Heba Farouk Mahfouz, Siham Shamalakh, Miriam Berger and Abbie Cheeseman

After four months of a near-total Israeli siege, Gaza’s few remaining hospitals now have wards for the growing number of malnourished children whose tiny bodies are just the width of their bones.

Doctors are famished to the point that they have dizzy spells as they make their rounds, medics say, and the journalists documenting their caseloads are often too weak to even walk to the clinics.

For months, aid agencies had warned of the coming crisis, as Israel halted the flow of aid to the Gaza Strip before attempting to replace U.N. relief efforts with

Israel’s severe limits on aid lead 1 in 3 to go days at a time without food

distribution points inside military zones. It was a move Israeli officials said was aimed at pressuring Hamas, whose fighters attacked Israel on Oct. 7, 2023, and continue to hold about 50 hostages who were abducted that day, about 20 of whom are still believed to be alive.

But testimonies from doctors, relief workers and Gazans this week make it clear that a worst-case scenario is finally unfolding: Nearly 1 in 3 people are going multiple days without eating, according to the United Nations,

and hospitals are reporting rising deaths from malnutrition and starvation.

In a video filmed Tuesday inside Nasser Hospital in southern Gaza, families fretted over babies with distended bellies and tiny fists that they clenched as they cried. In one of the newly established malnutrition rooms, the mothers and children were so quiet that the loudest sound came from a pair of fans that beat weakly in the cloying heat.

The Gaza Health Ministry said Wednesday that 10 people had died of starvation in the previous 24 hours, bringing the total number of those killed by hunger to 111 since the start of the war. Among them was 6-week-old Youssef al-Safadi, so small in photographs from the silver table of the hospital morgue that the

white sleepsuit peeled back to show how his jutting ribs dwarfed his slight body.

The International Rescue Committee, a global relief and development organization, said Wednesday that its teams had reported an increase in the number of children being rushed to hospitals because of malnutrition in recent days.

“Their small bodies are shutting down. They can’t breathe; their immune systems are collapsing,” said Scott Lea, the organization’s acting country director for the Palestinian territories.

SEE **GAZA** ON **A12**

West Bank: Deaths shake a village where many are U.S. citizens. **A11**

A Palestinian state: France will recognize it, Macron says. **A13**

White House touts deal that critics call ‘chilling’

Columbia settlement is a new stage in bid to exert control over top colleges

BY SUSAN SVRLUGA, LAURA MECKLER, JUSTINE MCDANIEL AND JOANNA SLATER

The Trump administration hailed its deal with Columbia University as a victory and a template for agreements with other institutions on Thursday, even as concerns mounted that the settlement represents an unprecedented intervention by the government in the inner workings of higher education.

Under the terms of the deal, announced late Wednesday, Columbia will pay more than \$200 million to settle claims over anti-Semitism and discriminatory hiring. In return, the government will unfreeze more than \$1 billion in federal grants and funding to the university.

The settlement represents a dramatic new stage of President Donald Trump’s aggressive effort to exert control over some of the nation’s most prestigious college campuses, cracking down on anti-Jewish bias as well as diversity, equity and inclusion initiatives

and demanding a shift away from a liberal worldview.

In agreeing to the deal, the elite Ivy League institution in New York City is entering uncharted territory: It is making an enormous payment to the federal government despite not admitting any wrongdoing while relinquishing a certain measure of oversight to an independent monitor.

Columbia’s deal follows one between the University of Pennsylvania and the Trump administration this month. The administration had announced this spring that it was freezing \$175 million to Penn over its policies on transgender athletes — which were in alignment with the NCAA’s rules at the time. Penn agreed to no longer allow transgender women to compete on its female teams and said it would send apology letters to swimmers who were affected by its policy.

The Columbia agreement, months in the making, came as the school had grown increasingly concerned about its ability to maintain some of its research operations in the face of the funding freezes. It stipulates that the government will not have authority to dictate Columbia’s admissions decisions, hiring or the content of

SEE **COLUMBIA** ON **A4**

Harvard: The State Department is investigating its use of J-1 visas. **A4**

TERRY BOLLEA 1953-2025

Wrestler saw drama in, out of ring

BY BEN SUMNER



PAUL KANE/GETTY IMAGES

Terry Bollea, a.k.a. Hulk Hogan, at a 2009 event in Perth, Australia, one of many in a decades-long wrestling career.

Terry Bollea, the Florida wrestler who shot to superstardom as Hulk Hogan and whose tabloid-centric private life became a legal battleground over the First Amendment, died Thursday in Clearwater Beach, Florida, the Clearwater Police Department and World Wrestling Entertainment said. He was 71.

Emergency personnel responded to a call for a cardiac arrest and took him to Morton Plant Hospital, where he was pronounced dead, Clearwater police said.

For a generation of professional wrestling fans, Hulk Hogan reigned supreme. During the peak of “Hulkamania” in the 1980s, the 6-foot-7, 295-pound grappler was the face of Vince McMahon Jr.’s company, then known as the World Wrestling Federation. Mr. Bollea’s likeness touched every corner of pop culture, including movies, television, video games, merchandise and even a chain of pasta restaurants.

With his deeply tanned skin, thinning blond locks, Fu Manchu mustache and red bandanna, Mr. Bollea flexed his “24-inch pythons” — the nickname he bestowed on his biceps — ripped off his shirt and preached words of

SEE **HOGAN** ON **A20**

Trump’s pick at risk over past remarks, inexperience

Nominee to lead office protecting civil servants has disparaged them

BY MERYL KORNFIELD AND CLEVE R. WOOTSON JR.

Paul Ingrassia is unlike any nominee ever put forward to lead the Office of Special Counsel — and his confirmation prospects are increasingly uncertain.

A 2021 law school graduate with no senior government experience, Ingrassia has mostly made himself known as a loyalist to President Donald Trump who repeats scorched-earth rhetoric, expresses admiration for controversial figures and shares Trump’s disdain for the federal workforce he would be tasked with protecting. One Republican senator, Thom Tillis (North Carolina), said he will oppose his confirmation — a rare warning sign for a Trump-era pick.

Ingrassia was set to appear at a Senate confirmation hearing Thursday but was withdrawn from the schedule at the last hour because members of the

SEE **INGRASSIA** ON **A9**

IN THE NEWS

Executive order President Donald Trump directed federal agencies to try to make it easier to forcibly hospitalize homeless people with mental illness and addiction issues. **A8**

D.C., Commanders make deal Council Chair Phil Mendelson set a vote on the RFK site after a revised plan was agreed upon. **B13**

THE NATION The IRS is looking into eliminating its language services for non-English speakers. **A2** Ghislaine Maxwell met with a Justice Dept. official about Jeffrey Epstein, her lawyer said. **A7**

THE WORLD Chinese and E.U. leaders met amid tensions over trade and the war in Ukraine. **A13** The U.S. fell in a ranking of the most powerful passports, while Singapore was at No. 1. **A14**

THE ECONOMY Copycats and store brands are having a moment as consumers seek cheaper alternatives to big-name labels. **A15** Tesla’s latest earnings report showed the ongoing effects of CEO Elon Musk’s falling out with President Donald Trump. **A20**

STYLE Amy Sherard canceled her upcoming exhibition at the National Portrait Gallery, alleging censorship. **B1**

SPORTS Emma Raducanu continued her comeback with a straight-sets victory over Naomi Osaka at the DC Open. **B7**

THE REGION A Maryland man twice sentenced to death for murders he did not commit has filed a lawsuit against those who put him on death row. **B13**

WEEKEND A younger generation discovers mah-jongg, a game often associated with seniors.

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